

OPTIONAL HELP

Use one hint at a time.

Return to the records as soon as a hint gives you a next step. The original hint levels and exhibit references remain unchanged in this edition.

If a scene has made you certain about somebody, ask which record supports that certainty. Caring about a person, distrusting them, or finding their explanation plausible is not a substitute for a link in the evidence.

The story can leave a motive complicated while the record answers a factual question. You are allowed to reach a firm identification and still disagree about the person involved.

The following pages retain their original hint folios. Read progressively. Keep the separate sealed solution closed until you have committed your answer.

Level 1 / A nudge

Read one level at a time. Cover the lower prompts if you want help with only one thread.

Which family?. The will gives more than a mother's first name. What distinguishes its Ada from any other Ada Reed?

The oldest claimant. An early birth date matters only after you establish the right parentage.

Nell's name. Look for records made before the inheritance dispute. A school may record the name someone answers to.

The burial. An index abbreviation is a starting point. What detail did the compiler omit?

The household. Whose childbearing history is recorded? To whom does the word daughter refer?

The decision. Apply all parts of the clause: the right mother, living at Henry's death, earliest born. Keep motive separate from identity.

Level 2 / Where to look

Read one level at a time. Cover the lower prompts if you want help with only one thread.

Which Ada? Compare E01 with E07. Then compare the father, residence and mother fields in E08 and E10.

Follow Nell. Put E13 beside E05. Continue through E09, E03 and E04. Use date, father, address and spouse together.

Follow the burial reference. E06 supplies a volume and folio. Find the matching reference in E11. Compare the full name and age with both relevant birth entries in E05.

Explain Rachel. Compare E03's childbearing columns with the marriage in E12 and the death notice in E14.

Decide the order. Write the dates in E05 on one line. Mark who died, then use E02 to confirm the claimants are living in October 1912.

Level 3 / Strong help

Read one level at a time. Cover the lower prompts if you want help with only one thread.

Clara's branch. The Greybank records agree on Samuel Reed, a baker, and 4 Orchard Row. E10 names Clara's mother as Ada Marsh. E01 identifies a different woman.

Two children, similar names. The burial is Lucy Ellen, an infant born in 1868. Ellen May was born in 1870. Do not collapse those two birth entries.

The nickname bridge. E13 explicitly records Ellen May Reed answering to Nell. E09 names her parents and Edward Mercer. E03 connects the Mercer couple back to Joseph's household.

The second wife. Rachel married Joseph after Ada died. Her zero births do not erase Joseph's children from his earlier marriage.

Your last comparison. Compare September 1870 with February 1872. The will expressly excludes preference based on sex or surname. The documents do not show what either losing claimant privately believed.